of the total budget). Most of it was on the budget. Including off-budget expenditure, public goods and services expenditure allocation amounted to Rs 6.96 lakh crore in 2020–21. Outlays for public goods and services were spread over about sixty of the 100 demands.

The expenditure on Defence constituted the largest chunk of expenditure on public goods and services. There was an allocation of Rs 2.09 lakh crore in Demand No. 19, Defence Services, though this is essentially revenue expenditure to cover salaries and other establishment expenditure of the Armed Forces. The demand head, Capital Outlay on Defence (No. 20), also had a substantial allocation of Rs 1.33 lakh crore, which also falls in the public goods category. Police (No. 48) had an allocation of Rs 1.05 lakh crore. The Ministry of Health's allocation of Rs 65,000 crore also comes into this category.

Redistribution expenditure at Rs 5.33 lakh crore was about one-fifth of the Budget. Including off-budget redistribution expenditure of Rs 1.13 lakh crore, total allocation for redistribution in Budget 2020–21 was Rs 6.46 lakh crore.

The Central government implements its redistribution function through hundreds of schemes delivering benefits in cash (direct cash transfer or wages) or in kind (education, skill development and so on) to households falling in the categories of destitute and poor.

The analysis of all the 100 demands revealed that the 2020–21 Budget allocated expenditures of Rs 5.33 lakh crore to various schemes and programmes that served the objective of redistribution. A big chunk of redistribution expenditure, like food subsidy payment through NSSF, had been shifted off-budget in Budget 2020–21.

Three demands with the largest redistribution allocations were Food and Public Distribution (No. 15; Rs 1.22 lakh crore), Rural Development (No. 85; Rs 1.2 lakh crore) and Agriculture (No. 1; Rs 0.77 lakh crore). Other significant demands include Women and Children's Development (No. 100;